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Virgil [Publius Vergilius Maro], Aeneid (19 BC): Book 1

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BOOK ONE

I'm the same man who once coaxed music from slenderest reed pipes,
Then, upon leaving the forests, I worked in the neighbouring ploughlands,
Making them yield their resources to even the greediest settler:
Farmers all loved this work. Now I turn to the horrors of battle,
ARMS and the man I sing of Troy,* who first from its seashores,
Italy-bound, fate's refugee, arrived at Lavinia's
Coastlands. How he was battered about over land, over high deep
Seas by the powers above! Savage Juno's anger remembered*
5 *Him, and he suffered profoundly in war to establish a city,
Settle his gods into Latium, making this land of the Latins
Future home to the Elders of Alba and Rome's mighty ramparts.
Muse, let the memories spill through me. What divine will was wounded,
What deep hurt made the queen of the gods thrust a famously righteous*
10 *Man into so many spirals of chance to face so many labours?
Anger so great: can it really reside in the spirits of heaven?*

Once, an old city existed, and Tyrian settlers controlled it:
Carthage,* a distant menace to Italy, facing the Tiber's
Estuary, rich in resources, ferocious in practice of warfare.
15 Juno reportedly cherished this one land more than all others,
Even than Samos. In Carthage she kept both her chariot and weapons.
This was her candidate city to rule as the king of all nations
If fate allowed. For this role she was grooming it even in those days.
But there was being produced, she'd heard, from the bloodline of Trojans,
20 Offspring that would one day overturn her Tyrian fortress,
People who'd rule far and wide like kings, full of pride in their war skills,
Sure to arrive and cut Libya's thread spun on Destiny's spindles.
Fearing this, haunted by memories, too, of a war from the deep past,
One she had fought at Troy for her well-loved Argives, Saturnian

25 Juno had never let fall from her mind these causes of anger,
 Savaging pains. For they stuck, stored fast in her mind's deep awareness.
 One was the Judgement of Paris* that bypassed, insulted her beauty.
 Hate for Troy evilled her eye. Add Ganymede,* raped and exalted.
 Burning with these thoughts too, she battered all over the high seas
 30 Remnants of Troy that the Greeks and their never-gentle Achilles
 Missed. She relentlessly kept them at bay, far distant from Latium.
 Many the years, fate-driven, they strayed over sea after salt sea.
 Planting the Roman nation's roots was a task of immense scale.

Scarcely had Sicily faded from view. They were setting their canvas,
 35 Spirits high, on the deep. Bronze prows ploughed brine into foam spray.
 Juno, who kept her wound eternally fresh in her bosom,
 Said to herself: 'Am I beaten, my plans all dead? Is preventing
 Teucer's descendant from landing as Italy's king beyond *my* power?
 Granted, the Fates are opposed. But if so, how was Pallas empowered,
 40 Just for the insane crime of a single man, son of Oileus,
 Ajax, to burn an entire Greek navy and drown all its sailors?
 Out of the clouds she herself hurled Jupiter's lightning; she scattered
 Vessels, her storm winds churned calm seas. And, so much for Ajax,
 Lungs thunderbolted, he vomited fire: she dispatched a tornado,
 45 Whirled him away as he died and impaled him upon a sharp reef rock.
 I, meanwhile, who rank as the queen of gods, Jupiter's sister,
 Jupiter's wife, have been waging war with this one single nation
 All these years. Will anyone now still pray for my favour,
 Offering humbly, on bended knee, his gifts at my altars?'
 50 Inwardly spinning such thoughts, heart blazing with anger, the goddess
 Comes to Aeolia, storm-cloud land, ever raging with tempests.
 Aeolus rules here as king and restrains with imperial power,
 Deep in a cavern's vastness, the struggling winds and the howling
 Hurricanes, bridling their rage with a prison's chains and portcullis.
 55 Hating restraint, they seethe all round their bolted escape routes,

Making the mountain roar. Here Aeolus, holding a sceptre,
 Sits on a high peak, soothes winds' fury, tempers their anger.
 If he did not, they would tear straight out and swirl away with them
 Oceans, land, vast sky, swept off like dust upon breezes.
 60 Fearing precisely this, the Almighty Father confined them
 Deep within caves, then superimposed high mountainous masses,

Gave them a ruler who'd understand, from a well-defined contract,
How to restrain and, upon his command, give rein to their movements.

Juno came humbly begging his help, and addressed him as follows:

- 65 'Aeolus, I come to you since the father of gods and men's ruler
Granted you power both to quieten waves and to raise them with windstorms.
Sailing the Tuscan Sea is a people unfriendly towards me,
Ferrying Ilium and already conquered gods of its households
Over to Italy. Make your winds hurricanes! Shatter their navy!
70 Sink them, or split their forces and litter the waves with their bodies!
I, by the way, have fourteen nymphs with simply outstanding
Bodies. The one with the prettiest figure is Deiopea.
I'll designate her as yours, join you both in a durable marriage.
Thus she can spend all time with you, in return for your service
75 Rendered, and make you the father, as well, of some beautiful children.'

Aeolus answered: 'My ruler, your task is but this: to discover
What you desire to achieve. My duty's obedience to orders.
You ensure Jupiter's backing for my control of this kingdom,
Such as it is. And *you* assign seats at the banquets of heaven.

- 80 You make decisions on who has control over storm clouds and tempests.'
This said, he pointed his spearhead down, then pierced through the hollow
Flank of the mountain. The winds, like legions marshalled for battle,
Stream through the portal supplied, blast out across earth in tornadoes,
East wind and south wind together, and storm-packed African tempests
85 Sweep upon seas, churn waters up from the bottommost seabeds,

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Curling immense and destructive wave-crests over the coastlands.
Then follow roars: men's shouts; rasped screeches of hawsers protesting.
Billowing up in a trice, clouds tear away heaven and daylight,
Blinding Teucrians' eyes; dark night settles ghastly on ocean.
90 Sky roars thunder above, air flashes and flashes with lightning.
All signs menace the men with immediate death and destruction.

Now, in a flash, shivers send all Aeneas' limbs into spasm.
Groaning aloud, he extends both palms, reaches upwards to heaven
Uttering these cries: 'Greater by three, even four times, the blessing
95 Chance gave those with the fortune to die beneath Troy's mighty ramparts
Under their fathers' gaze! O Tydeus' son, Diomedes,
Bravest Danaän of all,* why could *I* not have fallen on Ilium's
Plains, spilled forth my soul under *your* right hand? That's where savage
Hector was killed by Achilles' spear, where the mighty Sarpedon

100 Died, where the Simoïs snatched up and rolled in the swirl of its waters
So many warriors' shields, men's helmets, and valiant bodies!'
While he is bellowing this, fierce, screaming gusts of the north wind
Batter his sail head-on, thrust waves star-high to the heavens.
Oars split, the bow yaws sharply, the ship veers broadside to sea's swell
105 Just as the surge curves up, in a mountain of water, a huge Alp.
Some hang high on the crest, others see, as the trough opens vastly,
Land disclosed between waves where tempests rage upon dry sand.
Southerlies toss onto lurking reefs three ships they have snatched up,
Reefs the Italians call Altars, exposed in the sea when it's choppy
110 Like some monstrous spine hidden under the surface. The east wind
Blasts three more into shallows and sandbanks (a sad sight to witness),
Slithers them onto the shoals, then walls them in among sand dunes.
Right before his own eyes, one vessel carrying Lycians,
Trusty Orontes too, is battered by huge breakers cresting
115 Over her aft deck. The helmsman, wrenched from his oar, is sent spinning
Headlong. Three times round that same surge spirals the vessel,

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Spinning it down through its suctioning throat, and devours it completely.
Up bobs a swimmer afloat, here and there, in this drain of destruction,
Arms of the men, planks, paintings, and treasure from Troy fleck the waters.
120 Now Ilioneus' well-built galley, now valiant Achates',
Abas' vessel, the ship that is carrying agèd Aletes
Storm lashed, start to go down; in their hulls' seams, dowelling and tendons
Snap, locked joints split apart, springing murderous leaks shipping water.

Meanwhile, Neptune perceived that an unleashed tempest was raging,
125 Sensed that the sea was a thunderously massive upheaval of salt brine
Churned from its still, calm depths; and he found it deeply disturbing.
So, looking up, he lifted his tranquil head to the surface.
Scattered on ocean's expanse he observed Aeneas's navy,
Trojans beleaguered by high-running seas and the heavens' implosion.
130 Juno's plots and her anger in no way eluded her brother.
Summoning east wind and zephyr to him he addressed them as follows:
'Could you have so much trust in your family connections, you mere winds,
That, without my consent, you dare make earth and the heavens
Chaos again and create so monstrous a mass of confusion?
135 *You*, that I ... Wait! First business must be to bring calm to the waters.
Then you will pay for your crimes. *Your* lashing won't be just verbal.
Get on your way and be quick. And relay these words to your ruler:

Ocean's High Command and the savage Trident of Office
Weren't allotted to *him* but to *me*. His province is large rocks,
140 Homes, east wind, for your kind. That's the right court for Aeolus' bluster,
Playing at king. But the winds must be kept in their cells with the doors locked!'

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This said, more quickly in fact than he spoke, he levels the swelling
Seas, rounds up, then disperses the clouds, re-establishes sunshine.
Cymothoë (Triton helps her) does hard work levering vessels
145 Up from the jagged reefs. The god prises them free with his trident,
Opens the quicksands' vastness, levels the seas back to flatness
Skimming the wave-tops on feather-light wheels in his swift-running chariot.
Much the same happens* within a great nation, where lawlessness often
Bursts into riots, where people become mobs savage with passion,
150 Firebrands, stones start flying through air (fury furnishes weapons)
Then, if they happen to glimpse a man worth their respect for his righteous
Conduct, they're silenced. They prick up their ears and await his instructions.
He, with his words, brings passions to heel, lulls panting to calmness.
So all the crash of the sea died down, as soon as the Father
155 Looked at the surface, cleared up the skies, and with only a guiding
Flick to his horses, established his course, and flew on under free rein.
Tired out, Aeneas' men put all their strength into gaining
Landfall as close as they can, setting course for the Libyan coastline.
Deep in an inlet there's somewhere to beach, where the flanks of an island
160 Jutting across force breakers to crash and to channel their fury
Into its various coves. It's a natural port,* and around it
Vast cliffs shield both sides, dual rock-masses surge towards heaven.
Sheltered beneath these menacing peaks are silent, expansive
Stretches of safe, calm water, around which a backdrop of shuddering
165 Woods loom down from above, dark forests bristling shadows.
Under the seaward face, there's a cave where rocks dangle in long tusks.
Fresh running water within and ledges of still-living limestone
Fashion a dwelling for Nymphs. No cables are needed for mooring
Vessels, no grappling anchors to grasp onto land with a firm bite.
170 Here, with a squadron of seven ships left from his navy, Aeneas
Puts ashore. Trojans, ecstatic with joy at regaining the dry land,
Leap from the ships and establish themselves on the sand-covered coastline,

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Stretch out brine-encrusted limbs full-length on the beaches.
First action came from Achates, who struck out a spark from a flintstone,

175 Caught it in leaves, made a flame which he nurtured with kindling of dry wood,
 Fanned it to blazing life by waving the smouldering tinder.
 Next, though exhausted by what had occurred, they salvaged their wheat stores—
 Ceres,* swollen with brine—found equipment for processing cereals,
 Started to dry out the grains over fire and to grind them with millstones.

180 Meanwhile, Aeneas is climbing a cliff to survey the horizon
 Far and wide out to sea for a glimpse of the Phrygian biremes,
 Seeking a sign that, say, Antheus or Capys has weathered the tempest.
 Maybe he might even see Caïcus' arms on his tall ships.
 Though not a vessel's in sight, he detects, down below, by the seashore,

185 Three buck deer straying freely; behind them, straggling through valleys,
 Whole herds follow in single file cropping grass as they amble.
 Halting, he stands very still. And his hands grab the bow and the arrows,
 Weapons that faithful Achates is carrying strapped to his shoulders.
 First shots lay low the leaders, their tall heads crested with antlers

190 Branching like trees; then his shafts create havoc by routing the common
 Herd and dispersing disordered ranks into leaf-sheltered woodlands.
 He doesn't stop his victorious onslaught till seven enormous
 Carcasses lie on the ground: one for each of the ships in his squadron.
 Then, heading back to the harbour, he shares them among all his crewmen.

195 Next, he distributes the wine jars, the ones that the generous hero,
 Noble Acestes, loaded as gifts when they sailed from Trinacrian
 Sicily. Last, he adds soothing words, lulling hearts full of sorrow:
 'Crewmates, by now we are hardly strangers to evil and hardship.
 We've suffered worse. God will grant us an end to these sufferings also.

200 You've been close to the rabid rage and the deep-bellied thunder
 Roaring from Scylla's cliffs, you've experienced boulders the Cyclops
 Hurlled. Take heart once again and dispel your fears and depression.

.....
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Maybe the day'll come when even this will be joy to remember.
 Through all these varied events, these many critical junctures,

205 We're reaching out towards Latium, where fate reaches out to us, offering
 Homes where we'll settle in peace, where Troy has the right to reburgeon.
 Just hold firm, conserving your strength for the good days to follow.'
 Such were the words that he voiced. He, sick as he was with his worries,
 Masked his expression with hope, kept gloom in his heart, deeply buried.

210 Clothes hitched up, they tackle the spoils, make ready for feasting,
 Ripping the hides from the ribs, pulling out and exposing the raw flesh.
 Some hack meat into chunks and impale them, pulsing, on skewers;

Others set cauldrons of bronze on the beaches and stoke up the fires.
Then they revitalize vigour with vittles and, spilling all over
215 Meadowlands, fill up on vintage Bacchus and succulent wild game.
After they've feasted their hunger away and removed all the tables,
Comrades lost are the grief-stricken quest of their long conversations;
Wondering, poised between hope and fear, whether they should believe them
Still living or now dead and unable to hear voices calling,
220 Most of all, righteous Aeneas, who now mourns fiery Orontes
Lost, now Amycus, lost—though he keeps it all silent within him—
Lycus' fate too, and Gyas the steadfast and steadfast Cloanthus.

Now that the crisis was past, lord Jupiter, high in the bright air,
Looked down below on the sail-billowed sea and the motionless dry land,
225 Looked on its shores and its far-flung peoples, and paused upon heaven's
Summit. He focused the light of his glance* on the Libyan kingdoms.
And, as he tossed round, deep in his heart, such anxious reflections,
Venus, her shining eyes full of tears and grimmer than usual,
Spoke to him: 'Lord who controls the affairs both of gods and of mortals,
230 Ruling, eternal in power, bringing terror with flashes of lightning,
What could *my* son Aeneas have done to offend you so greatly,

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What could the Trojans have done, that they should, after deaths in their thousands,
Find that, to keep them from Italy now, the whole world has been sealed off?
From them Roman commanders were sure, some day in the future's
235 Rolling years, to arise. There'd be born, from restored blood of Teucer,
Men who would hold all lands, all seas, under their jurisdiction.
That was your promise.
So whose is the mind* that has changed you, dear father?
This vow was my consolation as Troy slid down to destruction:
Destined success counterpoising destined doom in the balance.
240 Now it's the same old fortune pursuing men driven by countless
Random disasters. What end will you set to their troubles, great ruler?
Antenor slipped through the midst of Achaeans, successfully, safely
Thrusting on up through the lap of Illyria's coves and Liburnia's
Deepest recesses and mounting his way to the source of Timavus.
245 Down comes the flow as the peak moans mightily, out through its nine mouths
Bursting, a sea with the roar of an ocean, all over the ploughlands.
This man has made it. He's founded his city, his home for the Teucrians,
Padua, given his people a name, he has put up his Trojan
Weapons. Now peacefully settled, he basks in tranquillity's calmness.

250 'We, your own children, to whom you accord full access to heaven,
Have, a disgrace beyond words, and through one individual's anger,
Lost our ships, been betrayed, held far from Italy's coastline.
This is your way of rewarding the righteous, restoring our power?'
Smiling at her, the begetter of life for mankind and immortals,
255 Showing the face that he uses to clear skies, pacify tempests,
Offers his daughter some kisses and speaks to her much in this manner:
'Spare these personal fears, Cytherea!* Your own and your children's
Fate that I've stated stays unchanged. You *will* see Lavinium's
City and promised walls, and you *will* raise great-souled Aeneas
260 Up to the stars of the skies. No one's mind has changed my opinion.
Since this anxiety constantly gnaws you, I'll make my pronouncements.

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I will unwind rather more of my scroll of the fates and their secrets.
He'll wage widespread war throughout Italy, crushing ferocious
Peoples; he'll give men civilized ways and fortified ramparts,
265 Till the third summer has seen him reigning as ruler in Latium,
Till he's camped three times in the winter and conquered Rutulians.
Youthful Ascanius, who'll now be known by a new name, "Iulus",—
"Ilus" it was while the Ilian state still ruled in the Troad—
He will go on to complete full thirty cycles of rolling
270 Months in command. Then he'll transfer the centre of power from Lavinium
And, with a huge show of force, make Alba Longa his fortress.
Over the next three centuries, then, this will be the command post
Ruled by the people of Hector, until such time as a royal
Priestess named Ilia, pregnant by Mars, gives birth to her twin boys.*
275 Romulus, happy to wear the tan hide from the she-wolf who nursed him,
Then will inherit the line. And, in Mars' honour, he'll found a city,
Giving its people a name he derives from his own name: the Romans.
I am imposing no bounds on his realm, no temporal limits.
Empire that has no end* is my gift. Even Juno, whose harshness
280 Now is exhausting the sea and the earth and the heavens with terror,
Will, one day, change plans for the better, and, with me, she'll nurture
Romans, that people in togas, the masters of all in existence.
That's my decree. And an age will come, as festivals glide by,
When Assaracus' house sets Phthia in slavery's shackles,
285 Famous Mycenae, too. It will conquer and master the Argives.
There will be born of this splendid lineage a Caesar, a Trojan.
He'll make Ocean the bounds of his power, and the stars of his glory,
He will be Julius—a name that derives from the mighty Iulus.

One day, anxiety gone, you'll take him up to the heavens
290 Loaded with spoils from the East. He too will be called on in prayer.
Then all wars will cease. These Ages of Harshness will soften.
Vesta and white-haired Trust, Quirinus, along with his brother
Remus, will make laws together. The merciless, reinforced iron
Portals of War* will be closed. Unrighteous Madness within them,
295 Sitting on weapons of murder, his hands bound back by a hundred
Bronze-locked chains, face bathed in blood, will rage in contortions.'

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This said, he sends Maia's son from on high to the newly built stronghold,
Carthage, so he can ensure that the land and the city keep open
Welcome for Teucer's men, so that Dido,* not knowing what's fated,
300 Doesn't just keep them clear of her boundaries. Mercury, flying
Over expanses of air, wings serving as oars, arrives quickly
Down on the Libyan coast, does as ordered. Phoenicians abandon,
As god wills, all fierceness of heart; and, above all, their ruler
Takes on a calmness of soul and a kind disposition to Teucrians.

305 Righteous Aeneas, whose thoughts spanned night in countless gyrations,
Took a decision, at dawn's first comforting light, to go outside,
Scout out the new terrain, figure out what shores they'd been blown to
And who controlled them, humans or beasts (he'd seen no cultivation).
Once he had answered these questions, he'd bring back news to his comrades.

310 So, camouflaging the fleet under cliff-tops eroded and hollow
Covered above with a woodland canopy—trees and their bristling
Damp shade circled the ships—he set off, having only Achates'
Company, clasping a matched pair of spears tipped stoutly in iron.
Deep in the forest, his mother approached him, assuming a virgin's
315 Face and attire, bearing arms, like an unmarried virgin from Sparta
Or like Harpalyce (*that* girl from Thrace can tire out a racehorse
And, in a sprint, run faster than Hebrus, a swift-flowing torrent!).
She, as if hunting for venison, slung, in their style from her shoulders,
Strung for quick action, a bow, and she'd let her hair blow in the breezes,
320 Gathered her flowing dress up in a knot, thus exposing a bare knee.
'Hey!' she spoke first. 'You lads! If you've seen, perhaps, one of my sisters
Wandering here, tell me where! She'd be wearing a quiver about her,
Over the hide of a dappled lynx. She could also be hunting,
Hot in pursuit of a foaming boar, and raising a loud cry.'

325 So Venus spoke; Venus' son then responded to her in this manner:
'I haven't heard, and I'm sure I've not seen, any one of your sisters—

What shall I call you, O virgin? For neither your face nor expression
 Seems merely human and, further, your voice doesn't sound like a mortal's.
 Surely you *must* be a god. Phoebus' sister? Related to some Nymph?

330 Bring us fulfilment, whoever you are, please lighten our struggle!
 Please inform us, at least, where under the sun we are stranded,
 Where in the world are these shores? We know neither the place nor the people;
 We are just wandering lost, driven here by the winds and the wild seas;
 Many a victim will fall by our hands to show thanks at your altars.'

335 Venus said: 'I don't think I deserve any honours of that sort.
 Wearing the quiver is normal style for us Tyrian virgins,
 As are the calf-high costume boots laced tight, and in purple.
 Tyrians live here. Phoenician settlements: Agenor's city,
 That's what you see, but on Libyan soil among war-toughened peoples.

340 Dido's the ruler in charge. She came here to escape from her brother,
 Sailing from Tyre. It's a long tale of wrong and injustice, a long tale:
 Twists, turns, full of deceit. But I'll summarize most of the main points.
 Dido had married Sychaeus, the richest of all the Phoenician
 Landowners. She, poor girl, loved him deeply. For she was a virgin

345 Child-bride, betrothed the first time that her father had checked wedding omens.
 Ruling Tyre, in those days, was Pygmalion.* He was her brother,
 And quite a monster of crime, far surpassing all possible rivals.
 Conflict arose among in-laws. Pygmalion, secure in his sister's
 Love for them both, lusting blindly for gold, killed Sychaeus in cold blood

350 Secretly, catching him quite off guard and in front of an altar.
 Evil, unrighteous man, he concealed what he'd done for a long time,
 Toyed with the lovesick bride, raised false hopes, crafted illusions.
 But in her dreams, the true form of her unburied husband approached her,
 Raising before her a face that was wasted with terrible pallor,

355 Baring the truth of the brutal crime at the altar, the daggered
 Breast, and disclosing each unseen crime concealed in the palace.

Then the dream urges her on to craft speedy escape from her homeland,
 And, as resources for travel, reveals where there's long-buried treasure,
 Massive ingots, silver and gold. No one knew they existed.

360 Dido, moved by all this, made her plans, sought allies in exile.
 All those who felt cruel hate for the tyrant, all people who feared him
 Keenly, assembled; then, pirating ships which, by chance, were already
 Outfitted, loaded the gold. So greedy Pygmalion's riches

Take to the open seaways—a bold coup, led by a woman.

365 'Putting in here, at this very place where you now see enormous
Ramparts, the rising castle of Carthage's new town, they purchased
Land, just as much as one could mark off with the hide of a single
Ox. And they called it Byrsa, "The Hide",* to recall the transaction.
What about you? Who are you? What part of the world have you come from?

370 Where are you travelling to?' In response to her various enquiries,
He gave a sigh, reached into his heart, gave a genuine answer:
'Goddess, were I to retrace the whole tale from its very beginning,
If you had free time to hear our chronicles, all of our troubles,
Venus, the Evening Star,* would end daylight and close up Olympus.

375 'Ancient Troy was our home, though I wonder if Troy's name has ever
Passed through the ears of you gods. We've been blown over various seaways;
Now, some self-willed tempest has beached us on Libya's coastline.
I am Aeneas the Righteous. I carry with me on my vessel
Household gods that I saved from the foe. My fame reaches heaven.

380 Seeking a homeland in Italy, I, mighty Jupiter's offspring,
Had, when I launched upon Phrygian seas, two squadrons of ten ships.
My goddess mother showed me my course. Fate commanded. I followed.
Just seven ships have survived, all damaged by high seas and east winds.
Nobody knows me, I've nothing, I'm wandering Libyan deserts.

385 Europe and Asia reject me.'
But Venus would suffer no further
Lists of complaints. So she spoke, interrupting his pain and his sorrow:
'You, I believe, whoever you are, are not hated by heaven.
You're still alive, still breathe; and you've come to a Tyrian city.

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Keep going, make your way out of this spot, get yourself to the ruler's

390 Palace. I've news. Your companions have made it, your fleet is recovered,
Saved when the eager winds from the north veered off, if my parents
Didn't misteach me my augury, didn't just fill me with nonsense.
Look, and you'll see twelve swans* in a row moving joyfully forward.
Jupiter's bird had been rousting them down out of clear, open heavens,

395 Swooping upon them from skies far above. Now they seem to be either
Landing in one long line or looking at others who've landed.
See: these birds, now safe, flap whistling wings. They are playful,
Now that they've circled the sky in a flock and have sung out their swans' song.
Knowingly then, I can say that your vessels and vassals have either

400 Made it to port or are nearing its mouth, flying under full canvas.
Just keep going, direct your step wherever the path leads.'

This said, she turned on her heels. And her neck gleamed brightly as roses;
 Down from her head, her ambrosial hair breathed heavenly perfumes
 Gods breathe forth, and her dress streamed down to the top of her ankles,
 405 Making it clear, as she walked, that she was a real goddess. Aeneas
 Now recognized his mother. He spoke to her thus as she vanished:
 'You're cruel too! Oh how often you toy with me, crafting illusions!
 Why? I'm your son! Why can't we ever link *our* right hands together,
 Why are we never allowed to hear genuine questions and answers?'
 410 Such were the charges he made while directing his steps to the city.
 Venus with her divine power, fenced them, as they walked, with a rampart,
 Fashioned from opaque air, pouring cloud in a deep misty mantle
 Round them, so no one could see them and no one could touch them or even
 Cause them delay, or interrogate them as to why they were coming.
 415 She, then, soars through the air off to Paphos, delighted to visit
 Her own home with its temple and hundred altars all breathing
 Perfume of fresh-cut blossoms and hot with the incense of Sheba.*

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Meanwhile, they've hurried the length of the route pointed out by the pathway
 And are ascending a hill whose menacing heights offer full views
 420 Over the city and look both across at, and down on, its castle.
 Awed by the massive construction, where once there were rickety hovels,
 Awed by the gates, by the noise, the paved roadways, Aeneas just marvels.
 Fired-up Tyrians work at their tasks; some extend the defence walls,
 Strengthen the castle and, with bare hands, lever masonry uphill.
 425 Some decide housing-sites, mark boundary lines with a furrow.
 Magistrates, legal codes, and a sacred senate are chosen.
 Others excavate ports, still others are laying foundations,
 Deep in the ground, for a theatre. Some chisel out from the cliff-sides
 Tall columns, massive in size: decor for a stage in the future.*
 430 Work keeps bees just as busy as this in the sunshine of early
 Summer across meadows covered with flowers when they lead out the now grown
 New generation from hives, as they store up the streams of their honey,
 Stretching the combs' wax cells to the full with the sweetness of nectar,
 Or when unloading the incoming swarm, or when, massed like an army,
 435 Driving those useless creatures, the drones, from the bounds of their compound.
 Work seethes; thyme's sweet savour enhances the fragrance of honey.
 'Oh, how blessed are people whose ramparts are already rising!'
 So Aeneas observes, looking up at the roofs of the city,
 Fenced, as he walks, by a fortress of cloud (it's a marvellous story)
 440 Moving along in their midst unseen,* yet mingling with people.

Centrally placed in the city a park, most delightfully shaded,
Marked where Phoenicians, battered by waves and by violent storm winds,
Landed and dug up the sign pointed out as an omen by ruling
Juno: the head of a spirited horse, foretelling the nation's
445 Future: distinction in war and in steady traffic of commerce.
Dido of Sidon was here constructing a temple to Juno,
Grand in its scale, in its votive gifts, in its goddess's presence;
Tall banked steps made approach to a threshold of bronze and its framing

pg 18

Bronze-bound beams, and the doors rasped open on hinges of wrought brass.
450 Here, in this park, something new first touched him now, and it gentled
Fears; now Aeneas dared, for the first time, dream of survival,
Dared to put greater trust in events, despite his reversals.
For, while awaiting the ruler below the huge temple, he took in
All its details, marvelling at how that city had prospered,
455 Noting the artists' skill, the combined success of their labours.
Awestruck, he saw the whole series of battles at Troy represented,
Wars that were already famed world-wide in rumour and story:
Atreus' sons, Priam too, and Achilles, savage to both sides.
'Is there a place,' he said, stopped in his tracks, tears flowing, 'Achates,
460 Is there a land in the world not steeped in our troubles and sorrow?
Look! Priam's here. Even here great deeds win due recognition,
Human events stir tears; what dies has the power to move minds.
Cast off fear! These rumours, this fame,* will bring you some safety!'
This said, he feasted his soul on the ghostly figures before him,
465 Groaning a great deal, bedewing his face with a river of weeping,
Constantly seeing the fighters circling Troy in their battles:
Greeks here, routed and hotly pursued by the young Trojan soldiers,
Phrygians there, pressed hard from his chariot by crested Achilles.
Not far away, he can see (and recall) the white canvas of Rhesus'
470 Tents* through his tears, men betrayed in their first night's sleep near the city,
Hideously butchered by Tydeus' blood-drenched son, Diomedes.
He seized Rhesus' fiery steeds, drove them off to the Greek camp
So they could not first crop Troy's grass and drink of the Xanthus.
Elsewhere, a young boy, unfulfilled, no match for Achilles,
475 Troilus, throws down his shield as he flees, borne away by his horses,
Rolls backwards out of his chariot, unseated, but still he is clinging,
Clutching the reins while his neck and his hair drag over the hard ground,
While the fine tip of his spear points downwards and writes in the dry dust.
Grim-faced women of Troy, meanwhile, hair streaming, unribboned,

480 Walk to the temple of Pallas—the goddess was hardly impartial—
Suppliants, beating their breasts and bringing a robe as an offering.
Head turned away, eyes fixed on the ground, though, the goddess ignores them.

pg 19

Here, selling Hector's lifeless cadaver for gold, was Achilles—
After he'd dragged that corpse three times round Ilium's ramparts.
485 Huge sighs welled from the depths of Aeneas's heart as he noted
His friend's plundered armour and chariot, his actual cadaver;
Priam too, whose unarmed hands stretched, pleading for pity.
And he detected himself, mixed in with Achaean commanders,*
Eastern contingents too: black Memnon's own special armour.
490 Here, leading thousands of Amazon troops, shields curved in a crescent,
Penthesilea appears, all ablaze in her full battle fury.
Bracing her naked breast with a halter of gold, a fierce warrior
Virgin, a woman who dares to engage with the men in their battles.

While these marvellous works hold Dardan Aeneas' attention,
495 While he stands stock-still, eyes fixed, gaze totally focused,
Dido the queen is approaching the shrine, supreme in her beauty,
Flanked by a numerous escort of youths. She appears like Diana
Leading her dancers out on the banks of the Spartan Eurotas,
Or along ridges of Cynthus in Delos, with thousands of mountain
500 Nymphs in a cluster about her, on this side and that side, yet towering
High above all of the rest as she strides, quiver strapped to her shoulder.
Joy even tempts the impassive heart of her mother Latona!
Such then was Dido and as such she bore herself: confident, cheerful,
Right through their midst, intent on her tasks, on the kingdom that must rise.
505 Then, at the entrance to Juno's shrine, and under the temple's
Shielding roof, fenced tightly by spears, she sat, elevated
High on a throne, issued laws, defined rights for her men, and she justly
Portioned out various tasks, or assigned them by lot, for completion.
Now, of a sudden, Aeneas observes, in a large crowd approaching,
510 Antheus, with him Sergestus, along with the steadfast Cloanthus,
And other Teucrians scattered by pitch-black gales on the high seas,
Driven far up upon different and distant points on the coastline.
Stunned stock-still, Aeneas himself, and likewise Achates,
Felt shock, ecstasy, fear, all at once. They are greedy to grasp hands,
515 Hot with desire, yet deeply disturbed by the whole situation's
Unknown nature. Maintaining disguise, clad in cavernous, veiling

Cloud, they are watching for clues: what has happened to these men?
Where is their fleet beached, why are they here? Delegations from each ship
Now are approaching the temple and shouting, yes, pleading for mercy.

- 520 Once they have entered, and gained their request for a personal hearing,
Captain elect Ilioneus begins quite coolly and calmly:
'Ruler and queen, to whom Jupiter granted the right to establish
This new city, the right to rein in with the firm hand of justice
Spirited peoples, we beg you, we suffering Trojans who've wandered
525 Every sea: keep fire, that unspeakable doom, from our vessels.
Spare us; we're righteous folk. Take a closer look at our quandary.
We did not come to annihilate* Libya's temples and peoples,
Nor to conduct pillage, rape, or to carry off spoils to the beaches.
Violence, pride such as this isn't found in the souls of the conquered!
530 There is a place that the Greeks call Hesperia. It is an ancient
Country, mighty in arms and strong in its richness of ploughland,
Tilled by men once called Oenotrians. But, Rumour says, their successors
Named both the people and land after Italus. He was their leader.
That was our course, as planned.
535 Wintry Orion, however, arose with a sudden upsurge of high seas,
Drove us on unseen shoals, scattered us, with the force of relentless
South winds, deep among waves that crashed over us, deep into hopeless
Mazes of reefs. We few that you see swam ashore to your beaches.
What kind of humans are these? What barbarous sort of a country
540 Tolerates conduct like this? Our welcome? They keep us from landing,
Start up a war and forbid us to take a step over their borders!
Even if you despise humankind and have no fear of mortal
Arms, be assured gods remember what's holy and what is unholy.
No man was ever more just than our ruler: his name was Aeneas.
545 No man was ever more righteous, more valiant in arms and in combat.
If fate still keeps this man safe, if he's still breathing vital
Air from the skies and has not yet succumbed to the brute world of shadows,

Mutual fear has no place. You could well, with impunity, battle
Him as to who was more generous.
In Sicily too there are cities,

- 550 Ploughlands, and someone of Trojan bloodline, the famous Acestes.
Please let us haul our storm-ravaged navy ashore on your beaches,
Cut down wood from your forests to craft new planking and oarage;
So, if we *can* go to Italy, comrades and ruler recovered,

We'll be elated to go off to Italy, heading for Latium.
 555 But, if our saviour is lost, if the Libyan seas have your body,
 Best of the Teucrians, father, if hopes for Iulus are useless,
 Still we can head back to Sicily's seas—that's where we've just sailed from.
 There we have homes that are ready for us; and a ruler: Acestes.'
 So Ilioneus spoke; Dardanians shouted with one voice
 560 Total assent.
 Dido relaxed her expression at this point and briefly responded:
 'Unknot the fear in your hearts, shut the door on anxieties, Teucrians.
 Brutal realities, newness to power, compel me to order
 Such measures, force me to post such guards the full length of our borders.
 565 Who couldn't know of Aeneas's people, of Troy and its city,
 Heroes, heroic deeds, and the blazing fires of a huge war?
 We Carthaginians are not quite *that* insensate and heartless,
 Nor does the Sun yoke his team *that* far from our Tyrian city!
 Whether you choose great Hesperian shores and Saturnian ploughlands
 570 Or prefer Eryx's realm, and to have, as your ruler, Acestes,
 I'll send you safely away, and I'll help, with support and resources.
 Or, you can stay here with me upon equal terms in this kingdom,
 Should you so wish. For the city I'm founding is yours. Beach your vessels.
 Trojan and Tyrian: both shall be one and the same in my judgements.
 575 I wish this same south wind had driven your ruler Aeneas
 Here, so he'd be with us now! For my part, I'll dispatch an elite corps
 Off down the shores with instructions to search the whole Libyan coastline.
 Maybe he's been washed ashore and is lost in our cities or forests.'
 Spirits raised by the words she had uttered, the valiant Achates,
 580 Father Aeneas as well, had been burning to burst through the veiling

pg 22

Cloud for some time. Then Achates spoke first, saying this to Aeneas:
 'Now what kind of decision suggests itself, son of the goddess?
 All is secure, as you see: our comrades and fleet are recovered.
 One's missing, true; but we saw him ourselves overwhelmed on the high seas.
 585 Otherwise everything matches your mother's report quite precisely.'
 Scarcely have these words come from his mouth when the cloud veil around them
 Suddenly splits wide apart and evaporates into the bright air,
 Leaving Aeneas fully in view in the daylight and gleaming
 Bright as a god in his face and his shoulders. For Venus the Mother,
 590 Sees her son's hair will have lustre, sheds youth's bright radiance upon him,
 Livening the glance of his eyes with joyfulness and with distinction,
 Much as a sculptor's hands* add sheen to an ivory, or as

Deep yellow gold gives a highlight to silver or marble from Paros.
 Speaking these words to the queen, he startles them all with his sudden
 595 Visible presence: 'You're looking for me. I am right here before you,
 Trojan Aeneas, snatched from the storms upon Libyan waters.
 You, you alone, have shown pity for Troy's inexpressible anguish,
 Pitied us remnants missed by the Greeks, who've absorbed each disaster
 Land and sea can inflict, who are utterly destitute. Yet you
 600 Give us a share in your city and home. We have not the resources,
 Dido, to pay back in full what we owe you, nor have other fragments
 Left of our Dardan race scattered anywhere else on the wide earth.
 If there exist any powers watching over the righteous, if somewhere
 Justice rules, if there's somewhere a mind that's aware of what's proper,
 605 Oh, may the gods repay you in kind! What age of contentment
 Bore you? What marvellous parents produced so noble a daughter?
 While rivers flow to the seas, while shadows sweep across mountain
 Vales each day, while stars are grazed on the pastures of heaven,
 You, your name and your glory, the praise you've earned, will for ever
 610 Live and endure, whatever land calls me.' This said, he extended
 One hand to dear Ilioneus, his right, and his left to Serestus,
 Then greeted others: both Gyas the steadfast and steadfast Cloanthus.
 Stunned by her first sight of the man, by his massive misfortunes,
 Dido of Sidon shaped her response: 'Son born to a goddess,

pg 23

615 What force of chance has been dogging your heels throughout all of these dangers?
 What kind of violence haunted your way to this menacing coastline?
 You, then, are famous Aeneas, the child blessed Venus once bore to
 Dardanus' offspring, Anchises, near Simoïs' waters in Phrygia?
 I myself can recall when Teucer* came over to Sidon.
 620 He'd been expelled from his homeland and was, with assistance from Belus,
 Looking for some new realm. Now Belus, my father, was looting
 Cyprus of treasures at that time; he'd conquered it, made it his fiefdom.
 Ever since that day the city of Troy, what misfortunes befell it,
 Your name, the kings of Pelasgian Greeks, have been part of my knowledge.
 625 Teucer, your foe, used to speak very well of his foemen, the Teucrians,
 Claiming that he was himself born of ancient Teucrian lineage.
 So then, young men, come on in, move into our homes. Make them your homes.
 Fortune has battered me too, with some similar twists, through so many
 Trials, yet finally willed that I settle down here in this country.
 630 I am no stranger to hardship. I'm learning to help those who suffer.'

So her words ran; action followed at once. She conducted Aeneas
 Into her halls, ordered sacrifice offered in all the gods' temples,
 Sent, simultaneously, down to his friends (who were still on the seashore)
 Twenty bulls and a hundred hogs, hides bristling and massive,
 635 Also a hundred well-fed lambs along with their mothers,
 Gifts for the day's celebrations.
 Inside, the palace is given the feel of extravagant, regal
 Luxury. Places are set in the central hall for a banquet:
 Fabrics produced by long, skilled toil and the proud purple mollusc;*
 640 Massive silver plates on the tables, a service with golden
 Inlay, narrating ancestral deeds in an endless procession
 Through many heroes back to the ancient birth of their people.
 Love would not let Aeneas's mind stop nursing a father's
 Thoughts. So Achates was sent, at a run, to the ships to bring instant

pg 24

645 News to Ascanius, then bring the boy with him back to the city.
 All care a parent can feel he lavished on his dear Ascanius.
 Further, he ordered that presents be brought, pieces snatched from the Trojan
 Ruins: a mantle stiffened with figured designs and with gold thread;
 Also a veil, trim borders embroidered with saffron acanthus,
 650 Finery Argive Helen had brought* from Mycenae when sailing
 Over to Pergamum, fully intent on an unapproved wedding.
 Wonderful handwork it was and a present from Leda, her mother;
 Also a sceptre that, in past times, Ilione, the eldest
 Daughter of Priam, had carried, along with her pearl-studded necklace,
 655 Even her two-tiered golden crown with its setting of gemstones.
 Charged with these orders, Achates sped off to the ships at their moorings.

Venus, Cythera's goddess, however, was spinning some new tricks,
 New plots deep in her heart. Her intent was that Cupid, her own child,*
 Switch his appearance and face, then come in to replace sweet Ascanius,
 660 Madden the queen, kindle fire with the gifts, set her bone-marrow blazing.
 Moods at the palace, she feared, could shift; double-talk was a Tyrian
 Art-form. Juno was ruthless—that burned in her mind, and at night-time
 Anxious cares coursed back. So she said this to Love, wingèd Amor:
 'Son, you're my strength, you alone are the principal source of my power.
 665 Thunderbolts mighty Jupiter launched at Typhoeus don't worry
 You. So it's you that I run to and kneel to, whose grace I'm beseeching.
 You're well aware that Aeneas, your brother,* is now being harried,
 Tossed all over the world by the bitter hatred of Juno.

You've felt my rue and my pain, often sharing that ruefulness with me.

670 Now a Phoenician, Dido, controls him, and she, with her smooth talk,
Makes him delay. I'm afraid of the ends to which Juno might channel
This hospitality. *She* won't stop at this pivotal moment.
My plan is then: Strike first; take the queen by a ruse, with encircling

pg 25

Fences of fire so she won't change course through divine interference,

675 Bind her to me, then, with bonds of a mighty love for Aeneas.
Now, as to how you can manage this task. Just pursue my suggestion.
My chief concern is the royal prince. He's at this time preparing,
At his dear father's behest, to come into the city of Carthage
Carrying gifts that survived both the burning of Troy and the voyage.
680 I, then, will drug him to sleep and I'll tuck him away in my sacred
Shrine in Cythera's heights or within my Idalian temple
So he has no way to learn, or to hinder, the ruse I'm devising.
Your job is making the ruse work on Dido by feigning his features,*
Just for one night, no more. You're a boy. A boy's facial expressions
685 Are, thus, familiar to you. So, when Bacchic juices are flowing
During the banquet, when Dido takes *you* in her lap, oh so blissful,
Hugs you and cuddles you, plants on your forehead a few tender kisses,
You can rouse unseen fire, deceive her with venomous love-draughts.'
Amor obeys his dear mother's instructions and now sheds his feathered
690 Wings, takes Iulus's manner and mien and enjoys what he's doing.
Venus, for her part, drips sleep's calming dew on Ascanius'
Limbs, and then carries him up, nestled close to her breast, to her gardens
High on Idalia, where marjoram softly enfolds him in gently
Shaded embrace as it soothes him with fragrant breath from its flowers.
695 Cupid, obeying his parent's words, strode on, bringing regal
Gifts for the Tyrians, thrilled that Achates was there to escort him.
When he arrives, Dido's already taken her place in the centre,
Seating herself on a gilded divan, amid sumptuous draperies.
Father Aeneas and Troy's young men are joining the gathering,
700 Shown to their couches. And now they're reclining on coverings of purple.
Slaves pour water over their hands, serve baskets of Ceres'
Breads, and supply serviettes whose nap has been razored to smoothness.
Fifty storehouse maids inside lay dishes in long lines
Side by side, and keep light in the fires at the shrines of Penates.

pg 26

705 Then there's a hundred more, and a hundred boys of the same age,

Loading the tables with fine foods, setting out goblets for drinking.
Tyrians have also been crowding through doors set ringing with laughter;
They too are guided to pre-assigned places on needleworked couches.
All are impressed by Aeneas's presents, impressed by Iulus—

- 710 Or, rather, by the god's dazzling face and his staged conversation—
And Helen's mantle and veil embroidered with saffron acanthus.
She above all, the descendant of Phoenix,* cannot sate her senses,
Unfulfilled* and vowed as an offering for future destruction,
Burns as she stares, roused equally both by the gifts and the young boy.
715 After embracing Aeneas and hugging his neck, satisfying
All the quite genuine love of a father who wasn't his father,
Amor made for the queen. And she, with her eyes and her whole heart
Clung to him, took him, at times, in her lap, poor Dido, not knowing
How great a god set snares for her there to suffuse her with torment.
720 Amor, recalling his Acidalian* mother, now slowly
Starts to erase Sychaeus and tries to surprise, with a living
Passion, a heart where the fire has died and where love is a memory.

Banqueting now takes a break; for the first time, tables are cleared off;
Huge bowls placed for the mixing of wine are encircled with garlands.

- 725 Chatter crescendoes within; cascading voices roll on through
Huge halls; fixtures suspended from ceilings, fretted and gilded,
Gleam as the lamps light; torches ablaze rescue daytime from darkness.
Dido calls for a chalice of gold encrusted with jewels,
Weighty traditional vessel of Belus and Belus' successors,
730 Fills it with unmixed wine. Now the halls fall suddenly silent.
'Jupiter, people maintain *you* wrote hospitality's handbook.
Make the day happy for Tyrians and those who set out from the Troad,
Make it a day that our children will always remember! So grant it!
Bacchus, you give us our joy, so be with us; and you, goodly Juno!
735 Tyrians, celebrate our close bonding with your full approval!'

pg 27

So she spoke; and she poured on the table a flowing libation,
Then, the libation made, first touched her lips to the chalice,
Passed it on then with a challenge to Bitias, who, without pausing,
Drained the still bubbling cup—took a bath in its gold as he did so!

- 740 While other lords follow suit, a student of Atlas, the maestro,
Livens the air with his gilded harp. For the long-haired Iopas
Sings of the unpredictable moon, of the sun and its labours,
Origins human and animal, causes of fire and of moisture,

Stars (Lesser, Greater Bear, rainy Hyades, also Arcturus),
745 Why in the winter the sun so hurries to dive in the Ocean,
What slows winter's lingering nights, what blocks and delays them.
Tyrians encore, applaud. Thus cued, Troy's men show approval.
Talking of this and of that to extend night's span ever further
Dido, unfulfilled, drank deeply of love's heady vintage.
750 Question on question about Priam; many, as well, about Hector;
What was the armour the son of Aurora would wear into battle?
Could he describe Diomedes' steeds?* How great was Achilles?
'Come, better yet, tell us, guest, of the trap that was sprung, from its earliest
Planning,' she said, 'by Danaäns; of your own family misfortunes;
755 And of your drifting at sea. This summer's already the seventh
Season that's portaged you on all lands, and on waves as you drifted.'

NOTES

1a-d *I'm the same man*: the italicized lines were removed by Virgil's editors.

1 *of Troy*: I delete the traditional comma after 'I sing'. Troy refers back to 'arms and the man' as well as forward to 'seashores'.

13 *Carthage*: 'New Town' in the Phoenician/Carthaginian language. It was settled by colonists from Phoenicia (modern Lebanon), whose chief cities were Tyre (hence 'Tyrians') and Sidon, five hundred years *after* Troy fell. Carthage itself was annihilated by the Romans in 146 BC. A Roman colony (named in honour of Juno) was soon proposed for the site; but colonization did not start until 44 BC, under Julius Caesar.

27 *Judgement of Paris*: Juno's causes of anger are given in reverse order. Paris, son of Priam, king of Troy, was asked by Eris (strife as a divine force) to judge which of three goddesses was most beautiful. Each offered him a bribe symbolic of her godhood: Minerva (Gk. Pallas Athena: 'Wisdom'), Juno (Gk. Hera: 'Power'), or Venus (Gk. Aphrodite: 'Love'). He accepted Venus': the most beautiful of women, Helen, who was already married to Menelaus of Sparta. When Paris, accompanied by Aeneas in some traditions, abducted her to Troy, Menelaus called upon all those who had been her suitors (almost all major Greek heroes of the day) to honour their pledge to defend his rights to her. So began the Trojan War (and the linking of Aeneas with Paris). The *Aeneid* is, at the divine level, a continuation of the rivalry between Juno and Venus, 'Power' and 'Love'. Left on the sidelines is Minerva, 'Wisdom'—also overlooked in the art and cult of Augustan Rome.

28 *Ganymede*: usually placed at least one generation before Paris and also (but not always) linked with Mount Ida. He was abducted by Jupiter (Gk. Zeus), made immortal, and required to be (among other things) Jupiter's cup-bearer. His abduction is depicted on a cloak given to the winner of the boat race (5.250–8).

97 *Bravest Danaän of all*: Diomedes, who lurks in the background throughout the *Aeneid*, was Aeneas' greatest Greek adversary. Aeneas is saved from him in *Iliad* 5 (see Introduction). Aeneas' words of despair here are based on Odysseus' similar lament in *Odyssey* 5.

148 *Much the same happens*: the first simile of the *Aeneid* is political and compares divine to human behaviour, not vice versa. Epic similes often highlight differences among things compared. The winds do not act spontaneously as Virgil's rioters do, but because Juno has subverted the hierarchy of command. Some think Octavian is the righteous man to whom Neptune is compared, and are, probably, at least partly right. But there is a risky undertow. Romans knew Octavian had restored order with weapons, not words, and that Neptune was not his favourite god, but patron deity of his powerful foe during the civil wars:

Sextus Pompey, the younger son of Caesar's rival Pompey. Sextus took for himself the same epithet Virgil applies to Aeneas: *Pius*, 'righteous'. He also minted coins bearing the slogan *pietas* along with images of himself and Neptune, and even styled himself 'Son of Neptune'. Octavian suffered heavy losses to Sextus in naval campaigns in Sicilian and Italian waters, and declared, famously, that he would win whether Neptune wished it or not. He even had Neptune's statue removed from a procession on one occasion (see also notes on 5.813; 6.6, 42, 70, 109, 366, 863–4).

161 *It's a natural port*: Servius (on 1.159) says this is an imaginary scene based on the Punic colony New Carthage (Cartagena) in Spain. Virgil appropriately gives it the feel of a stage 'set', since it marks Aeneas' entry into a world and time not his own: Carthage had not yet been founded.

178 *Ceres*: both the goddess who is the energy of crops and the Latin word meaning 'grain'.

226 *light of his glance*: many ancients thought the eyes *emit* the light we see by. This is important in the case of Jupiter and Venus (in conjunction here). For they are not just anthropomorphic beings, but bright planets (or erratic 'stars' as the ancients believed) whose celestial positions vary. But Juno was never a planet. She is associated with air (Gk. Hera was explained as an anagram of *aer*, 'air') and with the clouds veiling the skies (blocking visual contact between earth and heaven). Iris (the Rainbow) is her messenger. Neptune, the Sea, was not a planet either; our Neptune, invisible to the naked eye, was undetected in antiquity. Other solar system gods are Apollo (Sun), Diana (Moon), Mercury, Mars, and Saturn.

237 *whose is the mind*: Venus insinuates that someone else (i.e. Juno) has changed his thinking. For more on this, see 10.628–32 and note.

257 *Cytherea*: a reminder to Venus, born in the sea and washed ashore at the island of Cythera, that what has happened to Aeneas at sea is not necessarily bad.

274 *twin boys*: Romulus and Remus. Romulus founded Rome as a Latin city and, in most traditions, killed his brother Remus, though this is not obvious from Jupiter's words. Jupiter assumes that Venus knows Romulus is raised by a she-wolf, the Latin for which, *lupa*, has a range of meaning like that of 'vixen'. Livy says some took the story as a reference to the wife of the shepherd Faustulus (he found the lads), who lived as 'a she-wolf [i.e. vixen] among shepherds'. Jupiter's comment that Romulus showed appreciation for his wolf-nurse by skinning her and wearing the pelt diverts attention from the double sense of *lupa* here. Romulus, after death, was identified as a god, Quirinus.

279 *Empire that has no end*: Jupiter's resolve to give Rome eternal power follows oddly on his failure to deal with Juno's storm (which might have killed Aeneas). Latin *fatum* means,

literally, 'that which is spoken'. So Jupiter's description of his words as 'destiny' is not quite 'fate' as Christian theologians understand it. He speaks with less certainty at the council of gods in Book 10. Male gods in the *Aeneid* pay attention to human affairs only intermittently.

294 *Portals of War*: the doors of Rome's Temple of Janus, the double-faced god symbolizing entrances (and exits), were closed when Rome was at peace—only three times up to Virgil's day, most recently by Octavian. In 7.607–20 the doors of a similar Temple of Janus in Latinus' city are opened, despite Latinus' objections.

299 *Dido*: founder and ruler of Carthage. Virgil follows the practice of most Greek and Roman poets in placing female characters at the heart of his work. Not only is Carthage ruled by a woman, but the chief gods of the *Aeneid* are female, as is one of the main Italian warriors. The most memorable seer and the demons of the underworld are also female.

346 *Pygmalion*: his name is Phoenician, first found on a Carthaginian pendant made between 673 and 663 BC, the preferred date for the foundation of Carthage (the traditional date is 814 BC). He is represented with Astarte, a Phoenician goddess sharing characteristics of both Venus (with links to Cyprus) and Juno (with links to Carthage). In Punic tradition, Phoenicians established the city of Citium in Cyprus, under Elissa, daughter of Pygmalion before Carthage was founded by Dido and Beles (called Belus by Virgil). In Virgil, Elissa is another name for Dido. Pygmalion's name is usually linked with his skill in making lifelike images. In Ovid he is a Cypriot artist who crafts an image out of ivory (see note to 6.893 on the significance of ivory). He falls in love with his creation, and Venus brings it to life for him (*Metamorphoses* 10.247–93). His descendant, Cinyras, fulfilled a promise to send fifty ships against Troy by sending one real and forty-nine *models*. He was himself deceived by his daughter Myrrha (= myrrh) into making love to her. Their child is Adonis (Phoenician/Hebrew *Adonai*, 'Lord'), born after her metamorphosis into a myrrh tree.

368 *Byrsa, "The Hide"*: the Carthaginians negotiated with local residents for as much land as they could enclose with the hide of one ox (they sliced it into tiny slivers to make a lengthy thread). Aeneas has not yet seen a trace of human habitation. He is still distant from Carthage in time and space.

374 *Venus, the Evening Star*: Venus is also the planet Venus, the evening star.

393 *twelve swans*: the omen implies that Jupiter (rather than Juno) is responsible for the plight of Aeneas' fleet. The swans represent the twelve other surviving ships. Swans are less often associated with Venus than with Apollo in Graeco-Roman myth. Though Jupiter disguises himself as a swan to attack Leda, mother of Helen, his usual bird is the eagle. Battles between swans and eagles, unheard of in nature but common in poetry, usually result in success for the swans, probably because the Swan constellation rises ahead of the Eagle, is pursued by the Eagle across the heavens, but (since it is more northerly) sets later

than the Eagle and thus 'survives' the attack. Venus may have 'staged' this omen as Juturna stages a similar omen in 12.244–64 (see note on 12.246).

415–17 *Paphos ... Sheba*: Venus goes back to her Cypriot cult centre in Paphos (linked with the Pygmalion story). Virgil's emphasis on the Sheban (Arabian) origins of incense (grown, as was the myrrh tree, almost exclusively in Arabia) recalls the Phoenician/Middle Eastern connections of Venus' cult and the story of Cinyras, Myrrha, and Adonis.

429 *stage in the future*: Dido's Carthaginians are building a theatre to stage plays hundreds of years before there were plays to stage. Columns for sets are a feature of Roman, not Greek, theatres. The first permanent stone theatre at Rome was erected in 55 BC. Another was being built as Virgil wrote. So too was Caesar's Roman colony in Carthage, which had a theatre (the old Punic site did not). Trojan War motifs (part of the Caesars' artistic programme) make sense in the new *Roman* Carthage, but not in the Punic city. Since Carthage had been levelled, salted, and cursed in 146 BC, some thought its reconstruction impious.

440 *in their midst unseen*: emphasis on Aeneas' invisibility is apt, not only because this is how Aeneas was protected from his foes at Troy in *Iliad* 5 and 20, but because Aeneas is now doubly displaced, in time as well as in space. He is looking at a city founded five hundred years after Troy's fall which has features of Roman Carthage from yet another five hundred years further on.

463 *this fame*: Latin *fama* carries more shades of meaning than any one English equivalent can bear. It derives from the same root as *fatum*, 'that which is spoken', and means 'rumour', 'gossip', and 'tradition', not just *positive* 'fame' (see also Translator's Note).

469–70 *Rhesus' / Tents*: if Rhesus' horses drank from Troy's rivers, legend reported, the city would not fall. See *Iliad* 10, and Euripides' *Rhesus*—the only surviving Greek tragedy in which Aeneas appears. Troilus' sorrows, the death of Priam, and the exploits of Penthesilea, described in the following lines, are found only in authors after Homer. What the Trojan War means to the Carthaginians (and where their sympathies lie) is a mystery. They boasted no connection to either side until this fictional moment invented by Roman poets.

488 *with Achaean commanders*: Aeneas sees himself mixed in (*permixtum*) with the Greek commanders, either fighting or fraternizing. Virgil situates his only authorial (and non-committal) reference to the negative Aeneas tradition on a building dedicated to an enemy god in an enemy land.

527 *We did not come to annihilate*: the irony is that Aeneas' descendants did come to do so in 146 BC.

592 *Much as a sculptor's hands*: Venus recreates Aeneas (who is from a different time period) so he can meet Dido. Comparison of Venus to a sculptor embellishing a marble statue recalls the illusions wrought by Pygmalion to deceive Dido. And Astarte, on the Phoenician pendant and divine counterpart of Venus, is the consort of Pygmalion who, tradition says, ruled Carthage after Dido's death (see note to 1.346).

619 *Teucer*: Dido is referring, not to Teucer, a founding father of the *Trojan* (Teucrian) people, but to Teucer from Salamis (the island close to Athens), a *Greek* warrior at Troy. His mother was Hesione, sister of Priam, king of Troy, so he is a blood relation of Aeneas. Exiled by his father when he returned from Troy, he went on to found another Salamis in Cyprus. But, as Dido points out, he does so under the patronage of her father, Belus. He is a client king with an overlord (a warning of what Aeneas' relationship to Dido will be, should their peoples join). Virgil's source here may be Sophocles' and Pacuvius' now lost *Teucer* tragedies. See also note to 8.157. 'Teucer' is one of the many famous names in the *Aeneid* applied to two (or more) people. In this case, both Teucers were famous. Often a minor person is given the name of a famous character to elicit 'echoes' of the namesake.

639 *long, skilled toil and the proud purple mollusc*: a disturbing line, which focuses not so much on the beauty of the finished product, but on what went into making it: the hours of toil at the loom, the extraction of the famous Phoenician purple dye from the crushed sea-snails of the Mediterranean (it took some 23,000 sea-snails to produce enough dye for a Roman senator's robe, according to Pliny the Elder). Thus the 'royal' purple is a symbol of both princely pride and princely oppression, as is most brilliantly expressed in Aeschylus' *Agamemnon*, where Clytemnestra cajoles her husband into walking upon purple-dyed tapestries as a symbolic re-enactment of his destruction of beauty (before she kills him). The idea that the sea-snail is proud of its contribution is surely ironic.

650 *Finery ... Helen had brought*: these (and Ilione's sceptre and crown) are the only items of women's attire mentioned among Aeneas' treasures from Troy. We never learn how he acquired them, why he gives them to Dido, or whether he identifies their previous owners to her. A queen in love might see them as tokens of affection, even a covert hint at marriage. Virgil accords them influence equal to that of Love in shaping Dido's emotions.

658 *Cupid, her own child*: Virgil follows the later Greek tradition of making Cupid (Gk. Eros) the child of Venus rather than a primeval god, predating Venus. Venus' actions recall Apollonius 3, where Eros is recruited by Aphrodite (Venus) to make Medea fall in love with Jason.

667 *Aeneas, your brother*: Cupid, also called Amor ('Love'), is Aeneas' half-brother. And *Amor* is *Roma* (Rome) written backwards (especially apt in Carthage, since Punic, like Hebrew and Arabic, is written right to left). Roman poets often link Rome and Love.

683 *feigning his features*: Dido is again deceived by 'crafted illusions'. Virgil never mentions the restoration of Ascanius, though scholars assume that he is restored after Aeneas leaves Carthage. Some later passages take on added interest if we don't so assume. Ascanius is also known as Iulus.

712 *descendant of Phoenix*: the Latin *Phoenissa* evokes both Dido's Phoenician identity and the phoenix, a mythical bird that lived for five hundred years, then cremated itself. From its ashes arose a new phoenix. Dido vows in Book 4 that an avenger will arise from her bones: a reference critics agree is 'prophetic' of Hannibal, who inflicted terrible catastrophes on Rome two cycles of the life of the phoenix after the fall of Troy.

713 *Unfulfilled*: see Translator's Note, pp. xlix–l, on this translation of *infelix*. The Roman dictator Sulla translated 'Felix', his nickname, into Greek as 'Epaphroditos', 'Blessed by Aphrodite'. So Dido, in a way, is *infelix* because she is *not* so blessed.

720 *Acidalian*: that is, of Acidalius, a fountain in Boeotia (Central Greece) sacred to the Graces, Venus' daughters. Venus has taken Ascanius to Idalia in Cyprus (1.681, 693); Amor adds two letters and repositions his mother's identity.

752 *Could he describe Diomedes' steeds?*: Dido probably already knows the answers, as she knows much else about the fall of Troy. It is Dido, not Aeneas, who tells us how long Aeneas has been travelling! Since Diomedes won the chariot race in *Iliad* 23 with the horses he captured from Aeneas in *Iliad* 5, Aeneas ought to be able to assess them. See 10.581–601 and note to 10.581. Aeneas does not answer these questions.